Participants

*Note, any league-partnerships or health-informed changes (e.g. COVID) supersede the default league rules below and will be emailed to teams in advance of the season starting.

NYC Footy leagues are open to any player over the age of 18 at the time of the season's first game.
All players must be listed on the team roster to be eligible to take the field.
All players must sign a liability release waiver online prior to any form of participation in any NYC Footy program or event.
Individual players may only be rostered on one team per division.
Individual (free agent) players must register for skill appropriate leagues. If an individual player registers for a league incompatible with their skill level (e.g. a P2 player in a P5 league), the player may be removed without refund. Visit our skill level compliance page for more details.
Free Agents are expected to attend the majority of scheduled games, which shows respect to the team and community by ensuring teams have enough players and can build chemistry. Frequent absences without notifying your team will result in suspension from league programs. Please update NYC Footy if your availability changes.
Free Agent Teams are formed based on player availability and self-assessed skill levels. While we do our best to balance teams, playing styles, team chemistry and competitiveness will vary.
By registering as a free agent, you acknowledge that team placement is based on player availability and self-assessed skill levels. NYC Footy cannot guarantee that the skill level, playing style, or overall competitiveness of your assigned teammates will align perfectly with your own preferences or expectations. We do our best to balance teams for suitability and ensure a positive experience for everyone. While most teams get along just fine, if you ever encounter any issues, please don't hesitate to reach out to us at info@nycfooty.com
Teams must register for skill appropriate leagues. If a team registers for a league incompatible with their skill level (e.g. a P2 team in a P4 or P5 league), the team will remain in the league to prevent schedule disruption, but will be disqualified from playoffs. Visit our skill level compliance page for more details.
During the regular season, if (and only if) a team shows up with less than the default player format (e.g. seven (7) players in our 7v7 leagues) but more than the number required to avoid forfeit (e.g. five (5) players in our 7v7 leagues), the team may pick up non-roster substitutes that provide up to one sub (e.g. up to three (3) players for a max of 8 players in our 7v7 leagues), if and only if the non-roster substitutes are registered players in the NYC Footy league and has signed a waiver.
In addition, non-roster substitutes cannot be recruited from higher divisions into lower divisions if they break our skill-restrictions. For instance, in a P5 division, no player above a P4 skill-level may be used as a sub. In a P4 division, no player above a P3 skill level may be used as a sub, etc.
NYC Footy operates on an honor system. If a team uses non-roster players to field a team, they notify the referee in advance. The opposing team may also appeal to the referee to confirm non-roster players are being used by their opponent. If the offending team uses non-roster players in a manner that does not abide by the above rules, the offending team must play without those players or lose by forfeit.
Roster changes are allowed **for the first half of the regular season only** (e.g. No changes after game 4 in an 8 game regular season). If a team experiences difficulties that prevent the team's roster from meeting the league minimum requirements after the midway point, the captain must email customer service to request an exception.
Non-Roster substitutes are prohibited from playoff and championship games. No exceptions.
During playoff games, captains may request a roster check, but at the beginning of a playoff game only.

RULES OF THE GAME

All games will be played in accordance with the Laws of the Game issued by IFAB and are available for viewing at https://www.theifab.com/laws-of-the-game-documents/.

Modifications made in these by-laws supersede and/or supplement the Laws of the Game.

INDOOR RULES (NEW)

Please note, referees will enforce stricter contact rules in indoor/small-sided games.

All players must wear shin guards.
On hard surfaces court (e.g. hardwood, gym courts) cleats are not allowed.
For 4v4, 5v5 and 6v6 format, when the ball goes out of bounds, the restart will be a kick-in. During the kick-in the ball must be kicked at “below-the-waist” height. If the ball is kicked above the waist the ball possession will change to the opposing team that will restart with a kick-in from the same location.
For 4v4, 5v5, and 6v6 format, Goalkeepers must ensure the ball touches the ground before the halfway line with throws, goal kicks, or punts. If this rule is violated, the opposing team receives possession from the midfield sideline.
All free kicks (including kick-offs, goal kicks, and corner kicks) are indirect, except for penalty kicks.
A goal cannot be scored directly from a kickoff, corner kick, throw-in, goal kick, or goalkeeper throw—the ball must touch another player first.
Goalkeepers may slide inside their penalty box only to block shots, make saves, or challenge fairly.
Goalkeeper changes must be reported to the referee or risk a yellow card.
At facilities with entrance doors on the field of play, doors must remain closed during open play for safety.
At facilities with entrance doors on the field of play, substitutions only on dead balls or when the team in possession has goalkeeper control*.
If the ball hits the ceiling, netting, rafters, or any overhead obstacle, it is out of play. Restart with a kick-in from the nearest sideline.
All substitutions must be made from the designated area.

**no substitutions on goalkeeper possession in the final minute of any half.*

CODE OF CONDUCT

Participation in NYC Footy is in accordance with our Ted Lasso Code of Conduct, which can be found here: https://www.nycfooty.com/ted-lasso-code-of-conduct.

COED GAME PLAY

Depending on the league, a full playing team can be five (5) or more players. In a 5v5 league, a minimum of three (3) players is required to start and finish a match. In a 6v6 league, a minimum of four (4) players is required to start and finish a match. In a 7v7 or 8v8 league, a minimum of five (5) players is required to start and finish a match. In our 11v11 league, a minimum of eight (8) players is required to start and finish a match.

Our default* protocol for female minimums is as follows: In our 5v5 leagues there is a minimum of one (1) female; in our 6v6, 7v7 and 8v8 leagues, a minimum of two (2) females; in 9v9 and 11v11 leagues, a minimum of three (3) women is required at all times. Depending on registrations, this can change on a league-by-league or division by division basis. We also run female-majority leagues. Please refer to the actual league or division detail page when inquiring about coed game play for your league or division.
If a team does not have the required amount of female players, they must play down a player. For instance, in a 7v7 league, teams playing with one (1) female will play with six (6) total players and teams playing with no (0) females will play with five (5) total players.
During the regular season only*, in leagues with 2+ minimum female requirements, a team without the required amount of female players *<u>has a choice to give the opponent 3 goals and replace one female spot with a non-female player.</u> If a team is down more than one female player, they will only be able to leverage the 3 goal penalty once (thus, said team will not have an opportunity to play at full strength). If a team takes a 3 goal penalty and a female player player arrives late that would meet the league minimum requirements, the team must revert to the official format and honor league minimums (however, the 3 goal penalty still stands).*This option is not available during playoffs.*
If a free agent team assembled by NYC Footy does not have the requisite number of female players on their roster, they will be labeled FAx ("x' signifies exception). In this scenario, the game format featuring an FAx team will reduce the female minimum requirement by one (1) female to protect the free agent experience.
The game format reduction will apply ONLY for the first two (2) weeks of the season, allowing 3 weeks for the team to leverage FootyHQ and other resources to recruit more female players. Starting Week 3, the 'x' is removed and the team is subject to the official format.
FAx Teams with a female minimum reduced to one (1) for their game(s) are not eligible for the exchange of 3-goals for a female replacement.
<u>Under no circumstances, may a team field a full strength team with only male players.</u>
NYC Footy operates alternative format leagues, like our FLIP leagues, where our gender requirements are different.

> FLIP leagues are formats that require a greater number of female players on the pitch. Our standard 7v7 FLIP leagues require a minimum of 5 female players on the pitch. Our FLIP 50/50 leagues require a minimum of 3 female players on the pitch in our standard 7v7 format.

There is not an off-side rule in NYC Footy for the majority of our leagues (excludes 11v11 leagues).
All free kicks (including kick-offs, goal kicks, and corner kicks) are indirect except for penalty kicks.
A goal cannot be scored directly from a kickoff, a corner kick, a throw in, a goal kick, or a goal keeper throw. The ball must make contact with another player first (this includes the goalie).
A goalkeeper cannot pickup a throw in.
Penalty kicks are taken at the top of the penalty box. Keepers may move from side-to-side on the goal line, but not forward on a penalty kick. There is no limit to the amount of steps the offensive player takes prior to kicking the ball during a penalty kick.
Opposing teams must give all free kicks seven (7) yards of space immediately or a yellow card may be issued for delay of game.
Slide tackling or sliding in a dangerous/reckless manner is prohibited. A goalkeeper may slide to block shots and make saves, but only inside the keeper's own penalty box. Any slide deemed dangerous/reckless by the referee will be penalized.
RULE CHANGE (Winter 2024): Substitutions are unlimited, and may be made on the fly (formerly on dead balls only), so long as the player subbing out is completely out of the field of play before the player subbing in enters AND the subbing team does **<u>not</u>** receive an advantage from the substitution.

> Exceptions to the "sub on the fly" rule are made for certain facilities, where subbing on the fly is deemed to be dangerous (e.g. Upper 90 Soccer Center, Chelsea Piers Field House, etc.).
> Goalkeeper changes can ONLY be made on a dead ball and only after notifying the referee and receiving approval. All keeper changes initiated on the fly may result in a yellow card at the referee's discretion.

All substitutions will be made from the same location for each team throughout the game (sideline or end line) as determined by the referee.

Violation of the sub rule (e.g. if a player subbing in enters the field of play before the player subbing out leaves), will result in an indirect free kick to the opposing team, unless an advantage is played (to the opposing team).

CAUTIONS AND DISCIPLINE

Yellow and red cards are issued under the same cardable offenses outlined by the USSF:

Yellow Card Offenses: Players receiving a yellow card are required to sub off for a minimum of 2 minutes. The offending player's team **can** substitute for the offending player. If the offense is deemed particularly egregious, though remaining short of a red card offense, the referee can have a player sit for 5 minutes.

Second Yellow Card Offenses: A second yellow card offense requires the player to sit out for the remainder of the match. The team **can** substitute for the offending player and does not need to play down a player.

Red Card Offenses: All red card offenses at NYC Footy are reviewed by the Referee Incidents Board and carry minimum suspensions based on the nature of the offense.

Sanctions fall into five categories ranging from standard in-game dismissals to serious misconduct, with escalating consequences for repeat behavior.

The severity of each offense—and whether it involves abusive or violent conduct—will determine the baseline and potential for extended suspensions. See our red card disciplinary protocol.

Players allotted a red card shall be immediately ejected from the game and must leave the field of play immediately for the remainder of the game.

If the ejected player was actively on the field of play at the time of the red card, the ejected player's team must play the remainder of the game down a player.

Players may be suspended for a single game, multiple games, the remainder of the season, or longer depending on the category of offense and whether it's a repeat incident. Importantly, certain first-time offenses may result in immediate expulsion from NYC Footy depending on their nature (e.g., discriminatory abuse or violent assault).

Accumulating red cards across seasons will draw heightened scrutiny and may result in league expulsion if a pattern of misconduct is established.

Any player shown a red card by a referee is required to provide their name to the referee when requested. If they refuse, the team captain is responsible for providing the name of the player receiving the red.

In the event the player and/or captain do not honor the referee's request, the captain will be cautioned, the game ended, and the team will register a forfeit with a -1 point deduction in the standings. If the scoreline at the time of the incident is greater than a forfeit loss for the league format in question, then the scoreline at the time of termination will stand, and the team will receive -1 point deduction on top of the loss.

If the player receiving a red card provides anything other than their real name, and/or that player is discovered to be unregistered, then the team will face additional sanctions determined by the league.

Upon request by the referee or supervisor, ejected players may be called for a review by the NYC Footy board.

Whether or not there was a caution given to a player, an incident involving a player may be called for review should evidence arise after the fact.

Any player who initiates intentional physical contact upon a referee or a NYC Footy representative shall be given a red-card and suspended from all NYC Footy programs indefinitely.

REPORTING AN INCIDENT

Whenever a red card offense or concerning incident occurs during a game, we ask you to fill out this form for an incident to be formally processed by NYC Footy or captains can submit incident feedback in the NYC Footy app.
To learn more about our incident reporting process, please visit here.

REPORTING A DISRUPTION

Whenever a game is disrupted as a result of facility or equipment malfunction, facility closure, referee delay, referee absence, etc., we ask you to fill out this form for a disruption to be formally processed by NYC Footy.
To learn more about our incident reporting process, please visit here.

UNIFORMS AND EQUIPMENT

Teams not re-using official NYC Footy jerseys will receive a new set during Week 1, including teams on a bye week. Jerseys must be picked up at the field during Week 1, or a 1-point penalty will be applied to the team's total (this includes bye week teams). If a team forfeits a scheduled game, an additional 1-point deduction will be applied on top of the forfeit penalty.
Team Captains are responsible for keeping and distributing any unused jerseys to absent players. Failure to do so may result in the need to purchase additional jerseys.
Free agents must pick up their jersey during Week 1 or arrange for someone else to do so. Missing jerseys may require replacement at the player's expense.
All teams must wear their assigned NYC Footy jersey (goalkeepers are excluded as of now)*.
If a field player takes the field without their official NYC Footy jersey*, the referee will award the opposing team one goal per non-compliant player, with no limit on the number of goals. Goalkeepers are exempt from this rule.

A previous season NYC Footy jersey **of the same color is acceptable.*

Goal Keepers must wear a different color jersey easily identifiable by the referee. Keeper Jerseys may be provided by the NYC Footy.
If a team wishes to wear custom jerseys, they must do so through NYC Footy's customization process. Email info@nycfooty.com for more information.
All players must wear real shinguards (cardboard or balled socks, for example, doesn't count) and high-socks in order to take the field.
All players must wear soccer appropriate footwear to play. No metal or steel cleats or spikes are allowed.
A #5 game ball will be provided for game play. Teams should bring their own balls for warm up..

GAME DURATION

Depending on the league and league format, all divisions will have anywhere from 18-28 minute halves with up to a five (5) minute break at half time.
The game clock will start at the schedule game start time. Thus, it is critical that you take the field in a timely manner to maximize game time.
Clock will run continuously and the half and game shall end at the expiration of time.
If a game is called due to injury, weather or unexpected circumstances, the game will be considered complete if it has reached the halfway mark or later.

FORFEIT RULE

Teams have a five minute grace period from the start of kickoff to field the required minimum number of players or the team will forfeit the game. However, there may be some occasions when games are unable to start at the scheduled kickoff. Forfeit time on these occasions will be when the officials call both teams to start the game.
Forfeits must be communicated by the designated captain in the league's "captain's chat" on WhatsApp.
Forfeits with advanced notice (3+ hours prior to kickoff) will result in a loss with a -1 point deduction to the forfeiting team.
Forfeits without advanced notice (<3 hours prior to kickoff) will result in a loss with a -2 point deduction to the forfeiting team.
Forfeits with no notice given will result in a loss with a -3 point deduction to the forfeiting team [New for spring 2026].
Forfeits resulting from not enough players arriving on-time will be treated as short-notice forfeit and a -2 point deduction to the forfeiting team.
The scoreline for a forfeit loss will vary depending on the format of the league, as follows:

5v5 forfeit = 0–6 loss [New for spring 2026]
6v6 forfeit = 0–4 loss [New for spring 2026]
7v7, 8v8, 9v9, 11v11 forfeits = 0–3 loss

Once a team captain announces a forfeit, it is considered final and the team cannot retract the forfeit.
Two forfeits in a season disqualifies a teams from playoff contention. Rare exceptions are granted based on special circumstances.
Three or more team forfeits may result in removal from the current league and suspension from future programs. In such cases, the team captain will not be permitted to register for a future season unless they provide a reasonable explanation for the missed games.
Free Agent Attendance & Participation Policy: Individuals and small group players are expected to attend the majority of their games and maintain active communication with their teammates. Missing multiple games (more than two), especially without notice, may result in being ineligible for future seasons. If a free agent team records multiple forfeits, the team may be disbanded and removed from the league

PLAYOFF RULES

All players must be formally rostered and wear their official NYC Footy jerseys.
Captains may request the referee to do a roster check at the beginning of the game. Roster checks will not be allowed after the game has begun.
Due to limits on field availability and ensuring our schedules remain on time, there is no overtime in NYC Footy leagues. If the score is tied with 2 minutes left in the game the referee will notify both teams that at the end of regulation, and will initiate penalty kicks.

Penalty Kicks

Players will take five penalty kicks, alternating genders (M-F-M-F-M or F-M-F-M-F).
If tied after the first five PKs then it goes one-on-one, alternating genders, until there is a winner.
Players go in order and then repeat in order. For example, if a team has three female players and five male players, the female players will begin repeating before all male players have gone (or vice versa).
The ball is placed on the top of the box and players can take as many steps toward the ball as they want.

The keeper can move from side-to-side on the goal line, but cannot move forward until the ball is kicked.
All other players must be outside the box and behind the kicker and remain still.

Players must be silent while the kick is taking place.

LEAGUE SCHEDULES, SCHEDULE REQUESTS AND STANDINGS

SCHEDULES & RESCHEDULES

Schedules will be posted prior to the beginning of the season.

Games are played rain or shine.
Games will only be canceled due to hazardous weather conditions (extreme temperatures, lightning, severe thunderstorm warning, tornado warning, hurricanes, field covered in a sheet of ice, etc.) or hazardous or severely limiting field conditions (e.g. field lights are not functioning or the majority of the field is covered in a sheet of ice).
NYC Footy will communicate via the captain's chat and/or via an email notifying the league of postponement or cancelation.
Note, we do not cancel games based solely on weather forecasts. Unfortunately, weather forecasts (e.g. scattered thunderstorms) do not provide accurate enough data, by location, to inform cancelations. Thus, we instruct our referees to conduct a "delay-and-play' protocol. This means that if games are on and thunderstorms subsequently enter the area, the game will be paused and players will seek cover. If after 15 minutes, the thunderstorms continue, the game will be called. Otherwise, the players will retake the field.
If a game has completed at least one full half and is subsequently abandoned due to player injury, safety reasons, or otherwise, the game is considered "complete" and the recorded outcome will be the scoreline at the time the game is abandoned. If a game is abandoned in the first half, the league will attempt to schedule a re-match. If the league is unable to reschedule the game, the scoreline will be recorded as a 0-0 tie.
If games are delayed as a result of weather or administrative failures, then the active game affected by the delay will be played in full and subsequent games will have delayed kickoff times (captains will be notified of the delay in the captain's chat). If there is not enough time to complete all games, then the last scheduled game will be postponed and subsequently rescheduled.
Please note, that due to limits on the number of available weeks on a permit, it can be extremely difficult to successfully makeup canceled games. Therefore, we cannot guarantee all canceled games will be rescheduled, but we promise to do our very best to try and reschedule games. **Players should be prepared for the possibility of playing rescheduled games at different fields, days or times in order to successfully make up the canceled games**.
If a team must forfeit a game that is rescheduled on a different day of the week and/or at a different field, the forfeit will be confirmed, but no point deduction will take place.
If a reschedule date is not made available to teams, then the game will be canceled from the schedule entirely. Depending on the nature of the disruption (e.g. act of God, administrative failure, etc.) compensation may be provided to teams in the form of credits or discount codes.
Note, similar to all soccer leagues amateur and professional, if a reschedule date is scheduled, even if at a different time and/or location, teams are expected to attend the match.
Teams offered reschedule dates are not eligible for credits or refunds.
For more information about our weather protocol, visit here.

SCHEDULE REQUESTS

Team captains may submit schedule requests at the time of registration, provided the request is made before the league schedule is published. Requests will be reviewed on a first come, first served basis and will only be considered for leagues where such accommodations are structurally possible (for

example, a bye week request cannot be granted in a league format that does not include bye weeks). To file a schedule request, please contact us at info [at] nycfooty.com.
For Free Agent teams, schedule requests may only be submitted by small groups consisting of six (6) or more players registering together. Individual free agents are not eligible to submit schedule requests.

STANDINGS

League points will be appointed as follows:

Win = 3 points
Draw = 1 point
Loss = 0 points
Forfeit = -1, -2, or -3 points.

The majority of NYC Footy leagues will be decided by a playoff. The number of teams that qualify for the playoffs depends on a combination of factors, primarily the number of teams in the division. For instance, divisions of 5-6 teams have a Top 3 default, divisions of 7-10 teams have a Top 4 default. Exceptions are typically made as a result of permit availability.

TIEBREAKERS

In the event of a tie, the following tie breakers will be used:

League goal differential.
League total goals scored
League Points in head to head competition in games between tied teams
Goal differential in head to head competition in games between tied teams
Goals Scored in head to head competition in games between tied teams
Coin flip – in the event that tie breaker reaches a coin flip, contending teams will be notified at least 24 hours in advance of coin flip time and location. Teams can send a representative witness to coin flip.

PRICING & DUES

NYC Footy collects dues on a team (captain) or individual (e.g. free agent) basis.
Captains are responsible for the entire team fee (NYC Footy does not collect full team fees from individual team players).
NYC Footy allows captains to make a $250 deposit to secure a spot. **Dues must be paid in full within 14 days of registration OR 14 days prior to the start of a season, whichever comes first.**
If full payment is not completed 14 days prior to scheduled kickoff, the team will be removed and the deposit will be forfeited.
If leagues continue to accept registration after the season starts, then registrations must complete payment in full at the time of registration. Exceptions may be granted for corporate leagues that require invoices to submit payment.
If a team captain needs NYC Footy to provide additional players, NYC Footy will help find free agent individual players. If successful, NYC Footy will credit the captain 50% the fee paid by the free agent to NYC Footy or the individual team player fee, whichever is lower (updated 2024).

Leagues are priced into categories or pricing “tiers” based on a range of factors, including:

- Demand
- Location
- Days & Times
- Field Conditions

For refunds and credits, please visit **our refund and credit policy**.

MISCELLANEOUS ITEMS

NYC Footy operates on an honor system, including honoring the skill level of play across NYC Footy leagues, which are governed by our “P” system. This means if advanced players register for a beginner league, this is a breach of our code of conduct. Moreover, if a full team registers for an in appropriate skill division (e.g. A P2 level team registering for a P4 division), as reported to us by league officials, that team will forfeit their playoff spot to another team.

NYC Footy will continue to work hard training referees to enforce all NYC Footy rules. However, in the event a team is playing without the appropriate equipment or gender requirements and the referee has not announced the violation, the opponent should notify the referee within the first 10 minutes of the game. If a game reaches a conclusion without NYC Footy rules having been enforced and teams notified if goal advantages were given (e.g. for not wearing the appropriate NYC Footy jersey), the scoreline will stand. If NYC Footy is notified of the violation after the fact, NYC Footy will use this information to address the referee, but will not retroactively adjust the scoreline.

Alcoholic beverages are not permitted on any field. We will be hosting off-field events with drink specials at neighboring bars. Please reserve your drinking to the bars, not the field.

Illegal drugs are not permitted at all NYC Footy sanctioned event.

Clean up after yourselves! Please help keep our NYC parks clean. Don’t leave empty water bottles, trash, or other items behind. Teams leaving messes will receive a warning on first offense followed by a loss of league points for future offenses.

NYC Footy is a fun adult recreational league for all to enjoy. Please help us keep a fair and positive vibe on and off the field.

Note: Certain league rules may be suspended on an as needed basis (e.g. if a major event may signify team quotas are difficult to fulfill) and will be communicated in advance to any/all leagues impacted.